

Product Thinking Document

SheStarts AI Career Counselor

1. Problem Understanding

Women restarting their careers after a gap face several key challenges:

- Uncertainty about which career paths fit their background and goals.
- Difficulty identifying the most relevant skills to refresh or learn.
- Pressure to explain career breaks positively while building confidence.
- Lack of personalized, practical guidance tailored to their profile and resume.

This product aims to solve those challenges by turning user-provided personal and career details into a supportive AI-driven career restart plan.

2. Design Decisions

- **Clear onboarding:** A simple login/register flow ensures only authenticated users can access personalized career data.
- **Structured assessment:** The Career Assessment form captures education, experience, gap details, skills, preferences, and goals.
- **AI report generation:** Gemini generates a structured career report that is both human-readable and easy to parse for visualization.
- **Profile-aware counselor chat:** The chat uses saved user profile data so answers are relevant to the user's goals, experience, skills, and resume.
- **Private dashboard:** Dashboard content is restricted to the logged-in user and shows only their own reports and metrics.
- **Downloadable output:** PDF export provides a polished, shareable summary of the latest personalized career plan.

3. Future Improvements

- Add interview question extraction and more specific readiness scoring for job preparation.
- Improve resume parsing to automatically identify missing skills and recommend targeted gaps.
- Add progress tracking so users can compare earlier and later assessments over time.
- Create a coaching module with scheduled tasks, milestones, and reminders.

- Replace SQLite with a production database and add stronger authentication for real-world deployment.

4. Scalability Considerations

- **Current prototype:** Streamlit + SQLite is ideal for rapid development and small-scale demos.
- **Production scaling:** Move to a service-oriented architecture with a separate backend and a managed database like PostgreSQL.
- **AI request management:** Introduce asynchronous API calls, caching, and cost limits for Gemini usage.
- **User data growth:** Add pagination, query optimization, and multi-tenant support for many users.
- **Operational readiness:** Plan for logging, error tracking, and secure environment management.

5. Summary

This document explains the path from problem understanding to product execution. The app balances rapid prototyping with useful, personalized AI guidance, while leaving clear opportunities for future growth and scale.